

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS



INDIA-JAPAN - 1

MODULE - 39

INDO - JAPAN RELATIONS

- India and Japan have long historical ties rooted in spiritual affinity and strong cultural and civilizational ties.
- Exchanges between the two countries were said to have begun in the 6th century when Buddhism was introduced into Japan.



- 1 The Japan-India Association was established in 1903. Indians arrived in Japan for the first time on ports of Yokohama and Kobe in 1870s for business and commercial interests.
- 2 Leaders like Subhash Bose and Rash Behari Bose have a strong connection with Japan.
- 3 After World War II, in 1949, PM Nehru donated an Indian elephant to the Ueno Zoo in Tokyo.



4 This brought a ray of light into the lives of the Japanese people who still had not recovered from defeat in the war.

5 Japan and India signed a Peace treaty and established diplomatic relations on 28th April 1952.

6 In 1957, Japan provided Yen loans to India

7 This treaty was one of the first peace treaties Japan signed after World War II.

8 In the post-World War II period, India's iron ore helped a great deal Japan's recovery from the devastation.

9 Prominent Indians associated with Japan were Swami Vivekananda, Rabindranath Tagore, Subhash Chandra Bose, entrepreneur JRD Tata.



POLITICAL

1. VALUE SYSTEM

- 1** India and Japan have several things in common
 - respect for democratic values
 - committed to human rights
 - encourage a pluralistic open society and
 - support rule of law.
- 2** Both countries have a common feeling towards the idea of Pan-Asianism.



POLITICAL

2. HIGH LEVEL VISITS

- 1 In August 2000, Japan 's Prime Minister Mori visited India and provided the momentum to strengthen the Japan-India relationship.
- 2 The visit to India of the Japanese Prime Minister Yoshiro Mori in 2000 led to shift in India-Japan relations with the establishment of the 'Global Partnership' between the two sides.
- 3 Since Prime Minister Junichiro Koizumi's visit to India in April 2005, Japan-India annual summit meetings have been held in respective capitals.



POLITICAL

3. CONVERGENCES

- 1 Japan is positioned as a key partner in India's 'Act East Policy'.
- 2 Japan has an ageing population with 23% of population above 65 years; whereas over 50% of the population in India is below 25 years.
- 3 In 2012, India and Japan celebrated 60 years of establishment of diplomatic relations. The theme was 'Resurgent Japan, Vibrant India: New Perspectives'.



STRATEGIC

- 1 When PM Singh visited Japan in December 2006, Japan-India relationship was elevated to the “Global and Strategic Partnership”. The two leaders also issued “the Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation between Japan and India”.
- 2 During the September 2014 visit of PM Modi to Japan the leaders upgraded the relationship to a “Special Strategic and Global Partnership.”
- 3 In December 2015, a joint statement for future of Japan-India relations, “Japan and India Vision 2025 Special Strategic and Global Partnership Working Together for Peace and Prosperity of the Indo-Pacific Region and the World” was issued



STRATEGIC

1. JAPAN ACT EAST FORUM

- 1 In 2017, An MOU was signed to set up the India Japan Act East Forum.
- 2 The forum was to enhance connectivity and promote developmental projects in India's Northeast Region.
- 3 The aim is to combine India's Act East Policy Japan's Free and Open Asia-Pacific Strategy in the backdrop of China's OBOR.
- 4 At the Second meeting of the Act East forum on 8 October 2018, both sides agreed to focus on expanding of Japanese language in North East, training of caregivers under TITP, capacity building in area of bamboo value chain development and Disaster Management.



STRATEGIC

2. BAY OF BENGAL INDUSTRIAL GROWTH BELT

1. Japan initiated the Bay of Bengal industrial growth belt in 2014.
2. It aimed at strengthening maritime surveillance and protecting interests of Japan in the Indian Ocean particularly in Bay of Bengal.
3. It is to connect South Asia with South-east Asia.
4. They want to contain expansion and advancement of Chinese sphere of influence.

1 Japan and India also work on Iran's Chabahar port, which India sees as a valuable link to Central Asian markets

2 Indo-Japan alliance in the Asian continent has global dimensions.



STRATEGIC

3. ASIA-AFRICA GROWTH CORRIDOR

- 1 India and Japan are working on Asia-Africa Growth Corridor since May 2017. It is an economic cooperation agreement between India and Japan.
- 2 It aims for Indo-Japanese collaboration to develop quality infrastructure in Africa supported by digital connectivity for the realisation of a free and open Indo-Pacific Region.
- 3 It is supported by several African countries, including South Africa.



STRATEGIC

3. ASIA-AFRICA GROWTH CORRIDOR

BENEFITS

- 1 Under AAGC, Japan will contribute in the state-of-the art technology and the ability to build quality infrastructure.
- 2 It will give priority to developmental projects in health, pharmaceuticals, agriculture, agro-processing and disaster management.
- 3 It will consist of four main components- development and cooperation projects, quality infrastructure and institutional connectivity, capacity and skill enhancement, people to people partnerships.
- 4 It has the potential of becoming counterweight to China's OBOR.



STRATEGIC

3. ASIA-AFRICA GROWTH CORRIDOR

CHALLENGES

- 1 China has tried to undercut the Corridor by pushing India and South Africa to merge the project with the BRICS platform, which would exclude Japan and dilute India's influence.
- 2 There are doubts about whether Japan has the resources to compete with China's infrastructure push.



DEFENCE

- 1 India and Japan have the potential of developing a closer defence partnership defined by regular maritime exercises and high-level political consultations.
- 2 There are various frameworks of security and defence dialogue between Japan and India including “2+2” Dialogue, Defence Policy Dialogue, Military-to-Military Talks and Coast Guard-to-Coast Guard cooperation.
- 3 Japan revised Article 9 of its Constitution to allow Japan’s self defence forces to act more like a conventional army.



DEFENCE

Important defence agreements between India and Japan are-

1. Agreement between the Government of Japan and the Government of the Republic of India Concerning the Transfer of Defence Equipment and Technology (2015).
2. Agreement between the Government of Japan and the Government of the Republic of India Concerning Security Measures for the Protection of Classified Military Information (2015).



BILATERAL DEFENCE EXERCISES

- 1 In 2019, India and Japan conducted second “Dharma Guardian-2019” and the second “SHINYUU Maitri-2019”.
- 2 They have agreed to proceed with coordination for the first India-Japan joint fighter aircraft exercise in Japan.
- 3 In October 2018, the negotiations of Acquisition and Cross-Servicing Agreement (ACSA) began. The Tri-Service Exchanges between Japan and India have been institutionalized, completing the triad. Coast Guards have regular annual exchanges since 2006.
- 4 India-Japan Defence Industry Business Forum, which was held on the sidelines of Aero India 2019 at Bengaluru on 23 February 2019.



COUNTER-TERRORISM

- 1 India and Japan strongly condemn the growing threat of terrorism as major threat to peace and security in the region.
- 2 They have called upon all countries take resolute action in rooting out terrorist safe havens and infrastructure, disrupting terrorist networks and eliminating financing channels and halting cross-border movement of terrorists.
- 3 The 5th Japan-India Joint Working Group on Counter-Terrorism took place in Japan in November 2017. During the meeting, they exchanged views on issues such as current regional terrorism situation, counter-terrorism measures in both countries and international cooperation on counter-terrorism and violent extremism.
- 4 In their inaugural foreign and defence ministerial dialogue in 2019, India and Japan discussed the threat posed to regional peace by terror networks operating from Pakistan and asked it to take "resolute and irreversible" action against them.



NUCLEAR COOPERATION

- 1 When India undertook nuclear test in May 1988, Japan condemned it.
- 2 Japan imposed sanctions on India, suspended political exchanges and cut off economic sanctions.
- 3 But in 2017, India and Japan inked the Japan-India Agreement for Cooperation in peaceful uses of nuclear energy.
- 4 This agreement reflects strategic partnership between India and Japan and will pave the way for advanced cooperation in energy security and clean energy.
- 5 They established that the development and use of nuclear energy to be used for peaceful purposes. This deal enables Japan to export nuclear power plant technology, provide finance for nuclear power plants to India.
- 6 Japan has agreed to assist India in nuclear waste management and undertake joint manufacturing of nuclear power components under Make in India program.



MARITIME SECURITY

1 Japan has had longstanding issues with China's maritime expansion in the East China Sea; and India's has had long standing territorial disputes with China. So, they can have a common strategic objective in countering Chinese hegemony in Asia.

2 Japan and India both have an affinity towards the US, and it was replicated in several projects like the Malabar Exercise and the Quad (US, Japan, India and Australia).

3 In November 2016, PM Modi visited Japan and the two countries agreed to work for prosperity and stability of the Indo-Pacific region through "Free and Open India and Pacific Strategy" and the "Act East" policy.



MARITIME SECURITY

- 4 They would promote cooperation in the field of capacity building in maritime security and Maritime Domain Awareness including through cooperation with other countries.
- 5 To further this, they set up Information Fusion Centre – Indian Ocean Region (IFC-IOR) in December 2018.
- 6 Both India and Japan want Smooth and Safe Sailing of Ships (SSSS) in the Indian Ocean and Pacific Ocean and want to enforce and maintain maritime rule of law.



MARITIME SECURITY

EXERCISE MALABAR 2019

- 1 India, the US and Japan began the 'Malabar 2019' trilateral maritime exercise in the Pacific Ocean.
- 2 India used two frontline indigenously developed ships- INS Sahyadri and INS Kiltan for the exercise. Sahyadri is a multi-purpose guided missile frigate while the Kiltan is an anti-submarine warfare corvette.
- 3 A P8I long-range maritime patrol aircraft was also sent to Japan for the exercise.



MARITIME SECURITY

EXERCISE MALABAR 2019

OBJECTIVES

- 1 The exercise is to further strengthen naval ties between the three countries and enhance interoperability, based on shared values and principles.
- 2 It aims to enhance cooperation and inter-operability, based on shared values and principles, between the three Navies.
- 3 Complex maritime operations in the surface, sub-surface and air domains including anti-submarine warfare, anti-air and anti-surface firings, maritime interdiction operations were conducted during the sea-phase of the exercise.
- 4 Professional interactions, sports fixtures and social events were also conducted during the harbour phase.



MARITIME SECURITY

OTHER NAVAL EXERCISES

- 1 Mine-countermeasures exercise (MINEX) were held in Japan in July 2019
- 2 In December 2018 “Cope India 2018” took place in which participated as an observer.
- 3 In 2017, Trilateral Naval exercises by Japan, India and US were held in the Bay of Bengal, as a continuation of Malabar series of naval exercises.



MULTILATERAL COOPERATION

- 1 The Japan-India-Australia-US Foreign Ministerial consultations took place in New York in September 2019.
- 2 The leaders reaffirmed the importance of supporting ASEAN centrality and unity for promoting peace and prosperity of the Indo-Pacific.
- 3 in June 2019, during the 34th ASEAN Summit in Thailand, “ASEAN Outlook on the Indo-Pacific (AOIP)” was adopted



MULTILATERAL COOPERATION

14TH EAST ASIA SUMMIT

- 1 India's announced the "Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative" to create a safe, secure, stable, prosperous and sustainable maritime domain.
- 2 The Ministers reaffirmed the importance of freedom of navigation and overflight, unimpeded lawful commerce and peaceful resolution of disputes with full respect for legal and diplomatic processes in accordance with the universally recognized principles of international law, including those reflected in the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS) in the South China Sea.



PM Modi visited Japan on 27-29 June 2019 to participate in G20 Summit held in Osaka.

They discussed issues such as

- Japan's assistance to India for the coalition on disaster resilience infrastructure
- fugitive economic offenders and anti-corruption measures,
- infrastructure works of Japanese companies in the North East.



MULTILATERAL COOPERATION

COLOMBO PORT

India, Japan and Sri Lanka are working together to expand the port in Colombo as part of efforts to balance Chinese inroads into the neighbourhood.

IMPORTANCE

- 1 Colombo port, through which 90% of Sri Lanka's seaborne goods pass, connects Europe, the Middle East, Africa and Asia.
- 2 It had traffic of 6.21 million twenty-foot equivalent units in 2017, making it Southwest Asia's busiest port.



MULTILATERAL COOPERATION

COLOMBO PORT

BENEFITS

- 1 The three countries will develop the east container terminal, located at the southern part of Colombo port.
- 2 The trilateral project's goals are to increase Colombo port's container volume and increase transportation in and around South Asia, India and Japan are also eyeing joint development of the Trincomalee port in eastern Sri Lanka.
- 3 The trilateral projects also involve developing a facility that will allow large container ships
- 4 Japanese Official Development Assistance and private sector participation will finance a portion of the project.



MULTILATERAL COOPERATION

INCREASED PRESENCE OF INDIA AND JAPAN

- 1 Colombo has sought to increase the presence of India and Japan in the island nation since 2015, after concerns about increased Chinese investment and 'debt trap diplomacy'.
- 2 Some of Japan's maritime routes run through the Indian Ocean region where India is the primary power, so improved capacity at Sri Lankan ports will improve the security of tankers and commercial ships.
- 3 In May 2019 an MoU was signed between Sri Lanka and India and Japan for collaborating to build a container terminal in the port.
- 4 Japan, is pursuing a bigger role, expanding security partnerships in the region and boosting its involvement in infrastructure projects.



- 5 In 2015, Japan announced plans of infrastructure projects in Asia, Oceania, and Africa.
- 6 As a part of PM Abe's Free and Open Indo-Pacific (FOIP) Strategy, meant to connect Asia and Africa and the Pacific and Indian Ocean, a joint project with India and Sri Lanka to expand an existing port at Trincomalee in Sri Lanka, a joint project with Myanmar and Thailand to build a new port and special economic zone around Dawei in Myanmar, and a project with Bangladesh to build a new port at Matabari have been proposed.



MULTILATERAL COOPERATION

COUNTERING CHINA

- 1 China failed to make progress on projects in Myanmar and Bangladesh due to Japan's development plans.
- 2 India influence Bangladesh's decision to award the Matarbari project to Japan.
- 3 China has been accused of "debt trap diplomacy."
- 4 According to Japan has its approach is distinct from the BRI in important ways.
- 5 Its emphasis on safety, reliability, social and environmental considerations.
- 6 aligning with local development goals
- 7 Adherence to a broader rules-based order.
- 8 Japan also includes India as a partner and economic hub, whereas China's BRI avoids India.



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